

SUNDAY SCHOOL · AGES 6–9 · 7 WEEKS

The Way Back Home

Teacher's guide for ages 6–9

The whole Bible story in seven Sundays, from Eden to the open gates of home, told with the pictures and clips of **thewaybackhome.net**. Built for this age: real Bibles in their hands, a full memory verse each week, drama, small-group talk, puzzles and crafts.

Welcome, teacher!

Six- to nine-year-olds are ready for more than the little ones: they can follow a longer story, hold a whole verse, find it in a real Bible, act it out, and argue about it. They also think concretely and fairly, notice everything on your face, and lose focus after 10–20 minutes. This series gives them **one big idea a week**, one memory verse, one Bible-finding skill and one thing to live out, and changes activity often enough to keep them with you.

It follows the same seven weeks and book pages as the 3–5 and 8–12 series, so families with several children hear the same part of the story on the same Sunday.

The series at a glance

	Week	Big idea	Memory verse (CSB) · Bible skill	Kids' pages
1	**God's perfect home** The garden, The one rule (pages 1–2)	"God made it good, and He made me to be with Him!"	Genesis 1:31 Find the first book	Match the days of creation Memory verse fill-in + draw Comic strip: tell the story
2	**The big lie** The serpent, The fruit, Out of the garden (pages 3–5)	"Trust God, not the snake!"	Proverbs 30:5 Open to the middle	True or trick? Secret-code memory verse Twisty snake craft
3	**Every one of us** The long road, God's law (pages 6–7)	"Everybody sins. Me too."	Romans 3:23 Old and New Testament	Word search Verse scramble Story cards in order
4	**Locked out** Locked out, Can we scrub it off? (pages 8–9)	"I can't scrub sin off!"	Ephesians 2:8 The letters	Crossword Gift-box verse Comic strip: what are they thinking?
5	**The door** The door, The cross (pages 10–11)	"Jesus is the door! He took my place."	John 3:16 The Gospels	Maze through the crowd John 3:16 fill-in Door that opens
6	**He is alive!** The choice, The empty tomb (pages 12–13)	"Jesus is alive! He makes me clean!"	Romans 10:9 Luke and Romans	Secret code Mouth and heart verse Roll-away stone
7	**Welcome home** Heaven's gates, The new earth, Follow Jesus (pages 14–16)	"Jesus welcomes me home, and I can bring a friend!"	Revelation 21:5 The last book	Put the whole story in order A-B-C and the last verse Gates that open + invite card

In this guide

- How 6–9s learn, and what this series does about it
- A Sunday morning, step by step (60 or 45 minutes)
- Your toolbox: attention cue, class covenant, readers and non-readers, small groups
- The Bible-skills ladder
- Sharing the gospel with 6–9s; the harder pages
- Two pages per week, answer keys, sources

In the kids' pack

Short on paper or ink? Print only **page 2** each week (black and white is fine): the memory verse and the box for parents. Puzzles and crafts are optional; many can be done on a board or with scrap paper.

- Letter to families; Road Home map; bookmarks and invite cards
- Each week, 3 pages: **1** arrival puzzle, **2** memory verse (goes home with the "For grown-ups" box), **3** make or write
- Certificate

Pictures are real frames from the book's clips.

How 6–9s learn, and how this series uses it

The plan follows patterns common to evangelical elementary curricula and children's-ministry guidance. Numbers point to the sources at the back.

What we know about 6–9s	What this series does
Attention runs about 10–20 minutes, longer with objects.	The story is told in short bursts (book pages, then drama), and no segment runs much past 8 minutes. Every week has a real object to hold. [1][2]
They think concretely and focus on the parts and actions of a story.	Pause questions ask what happened and why. Comic strips, story cards and the 12-picture review make them put actions in order. [1]
They like to take part: role-play, drama, retelling.	Every week has an "Act it out" scene with simple roles, and children retell the story in their own words. [1][2]
One main point and one application works better than several lessons at once.	One big idea a week, and one "Live it" challenge for home. [1]
Reading takes up much of their energy; treat the Bible as the most important book.	Pair readers with non-readers. Use real, large-print Bibles; each week teaches one finding skill. Never give a worksheet that asks for no response. [2]
Early elementary Bible skills: find books, chapters and verses; Old vs New Testament; memorise verses; order events.	The Bible-skills ladder runs from Genesis to Revelation over seven weeks, with a tick-it-off bookmark. [3]
Memory sticks with chunks, motions, games and repetition.	Each week uses a different verse game (word scramble, erase the verse, discover the verse, balloon juggle…). [4]
Kids engage when they repeat back, move, talk in groups, help teach, and have a clear signal.	Small-group talk with answers for leaders; kids teach the motions; a call-and-response cue; a class covenant they write themselves. [5]

Sixes vs nines

A six-year-old may just be learning to read; a nine-year-old can read the whole verse, argue a point, and lead a small group. Every week has a line for each. In a mixed class, put one confident reader in every group.

Fairness is their superpower

This age cares deeply about what is fair. Use it: it's why the law page lands ("Is one lie enough?"), why we can't just pretend sin never happened, and why Jesus taking our place is astonishing.

A Sunday morning, step by step

Same order every week, so children know what comes next and save their energy for the story. Move on while they still want more.

0:00	**Arrival puzzle**	Kids' page 1 on the tables. Greet each child by name. Early birds help set out Bibles.
0:08	**Welcome**	Attention cue. Review the big ideas so far with the moves. Introduce today's big idea.
0:12	**Hook**	An object lesson that opens the big idea.
0:17	**Find it!**	Bible skill: everyone finds the memory verse in a real Bible.
0:21	**Story time**	Play this week's book pages; stop on each picture with the pause question.
0:28	**Act it out**	A short drama with simple roles. Then ask the audience one question.
0:35	**Talk**	Small groups of 4–6 with a leader. Questions and answers are on the week's page.
0:42	**Memory verse game**	Learn the verse with this week's game.
0:48	**Do it**	The week's activity: a game, an object lesson or the page 3 craft.
0:55	**Live it and pray**	This week's challenge, a sticker on the Road Home map, prayer. Page 2 goes home.

Only 45 minutes?

- Arrival puzzle 5 minutes
- Alternate weeks: do either "Act it out" or the verse game
- Talk in one big group
- Page 3 goes home if not finished

Kids' pages

- **Page 1**: arrival puzzle (in class)
- **Page 2**: memory verse + "For grown-ups" box (goes home)
- **Page 3**: craft or writing, done in "Do it" or at home

Set up the room

- Rows or a semicircle facing the screen, with an open stage area in front for drama
- Tables for puzzles and crafts
- Bibles (same edition if you can, so page numbers match) in a tub
- Download the book for offline use from the site's menu, in case the Wi-Fi fails

Helpers

- One adult per small group of 4–6 children
- Two screened adults in the room at all times, per your church's child-safety policy
- Give small-group leaders the week's two pages a week ahead

Your classroom toolbox

The attention cue: “Way back…” “HOME!”

You say “Way back…”; they answer “HOME!” and freeze, hands on heads like a roof. Same cue, every week. Kids this age also love a countdown: “Five… four…” (they join in).

Week 1: write a class covenant

Let the children make the rules (3–5 of them), then everyone signs. Kids who help set the rules are more invested in keeping them. [5] Keep it on the wall and point to it, rather than raising your voice.

Readers and non-readers

- Pair every pre-reader with a reader (“Bible buddies”).
- Read every puzzle instruction aloud.
- Word banks are on every fill-in page.
- Never make a child read aloud who hasn’t volunteered.

Quick redirects

- **Freeze frame!** The book’s clips freeze on the last picture. Call it; everyone freezes.
- **Repeat it back:** “Tell your neighbour what just happened.” [5]
- **Give them a job:** narrator, prop holder, page-turner. [5]
- **Move:** stand up for every “yes”, sit for every “no”.
- **Name and nearness:** sit beside the wiggler, use their name kindly.

Competition, kindly

- Teams, races and timers energise this age.
- Mix teams every week; never boys vs girls or ages vs ages.
- Celebrate effort and teamwork, not just winners.
- Use a stamp or sticker on the Road Home map for finding the verse, not for “right answers”.

The Bible-skills ladder

Week	Skill	Find it
1	**Find the first book**	Genesis 1:31
2	**Open to the middle**	Proverbs 30:5
3	**Old and New Testament**	Romans 3:23
4	**The letters**	Ephesians 2:8
5	**The Gospels**	John 3:16
6	**Luke and Romans**	Romans 10:9
7	**The last book**	Revelation 21:5

Sharing the gospel with 6–9s

Many Christians first trust Jesus as children. At this age they can grasp sin, the cross and the resurrection, and they can respond. They also want to please adults and follow friends. So be clear, and be patient: explain the choice in week 6, invite in week 7, and never manipulate.

The story in seven words (one per week)

Made (God made a good home) → **Lied** (the serpent; sin entered) → **All** (everybody sins) → **Locked** (we can't fix it) → **Door** (Jesus took our place) → **Alive** (He rose; He makes us clean) → **Home** (He welcomes us; we tell others).

Do

- Use the Bible's words: sin, cross, rose, trust, Lord. Then explain them.
- Explain that being good can't save us (week 4), so grace is a gift (Ephesians 2:8).
- Invite quietly and personally: "If you want to talk about following Jesus, find me after."
- Talk one to one with any child who responds; ask them to tell you in their own words what they believe.
- Tell parents the same day.

Don't

- Ask for raised hands or "every head bowed, every eye closed" counts.
- Use fear as leverage, or rewards for "decisions".
- Rush a child who isn't ready, or doubt one who is.
- Announce who prayed.

The harder pages

Week 2 · Fruit, exile	Lightning and thunder; animals die to make clothes. Say it plainly. It's the first picture of a substitute, and week 5 needs it.
Week 3 · God's law	"That makes you a liar and a thief." Let it land, about all of us, yourself first. No public confessions.
Week 4 · Locked out	The book names hell. Read it calmly, as written, then: "That is very bad news, but it is not the end of the story."
Weeks 5–6 · Cross, choice	One of the three children (Chase) turns away, then walks off. "He doesn't want Jesus yet. Jesus still loves him. Jesus lets us choose."

Supplies and prep

Every week

- Screen with **thewaybackhome.net** (downloaded for offline use)
- Bibles, one per pair at least (large print helps)
- Kids' pages 1–3 for each child, plus spares
- Pencils, crayons, scissors, glue sticks
- Whiteboard or flip chart and markers
- Stickers for the Road Home map
- Index cards / sticky notes for verse games

Before week 1

- Print the family letter, maps, bookmarks
- Test the permanent marker and rubbing alcohol on a plate (weeks 4, 6)
- Find a box and padlock (weeks 4–5) and make the tomb box (week 6)
- Recruit small-group leaders and send them weeks 1–2

Special items, by week

Item	Week
Cloth bag with 5–6 things from nature	1
Tape to mark one square on the floor	1
Pretty gift box with an onion inside	2
Plain bag with a treat per child	2
Kids' page 3 (the snake spiral)	2
Scissors, crayons, string or yarn	2
Hand mirror	3
Bucket or basket	3
Paper balls, 3 per child	3
Tape for a throwing line	3
Small round dot stickers	3
Box with a padlock (hide the key)	4
White plastic plate (keep it for week 6!)	4
Permanent marker	4
Water, soap, sponge	4
Last week's locked box, with the key	5
Kids' page 3	5, 7
Scissors, glue sticks, crayons	5
Box with a paper-plate "stone"	6
The marked plate from week 4 + rubbing alcohol and a cloth	6
Plate from week 4	6
Rubbing alcohol or whiteboard cleaner (test first!)	6
Paper fasteners (brads)	6
Streamers or balloons	7
Scissors, glue sticks	7

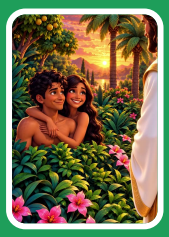
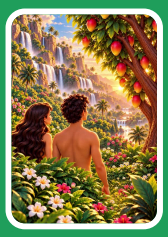
Running threads

- **The locked box**: nobody can open it in week 4; the key is Jesus in week 5.
- **The plate**: the mark won't scrub off in week 4; wiped clean in week 6.
- **Dot stickers**: sin marks in week 3, checked again in week 4.
- **The Road Home map**: a stop coloured and a verse reference written each week.

WEEK 1 OF 7

God's perfect home

Book: The garden · The one rule (pages 1–2) · Bible: Genesis 1:1, 26–31; 2:8–9, 15–17

Teacher's heart

Before there was a problem, there was a home. God made a good world, made people to be with Him, and gave them everything to enjoy except one tree. Six- to nine-year-olds think in concrete terms, so let Eden be real and wonderful: rivers, fruit, animals, and God Himself with them. The one rule was not God holding something back; it was a loving Father giving His children a real way to trust Him. The rest of the series only makes sense if they first see how good home was.

Big idea

"God made it good, and He made me to be with Him!"

Sweep both arms wide on "good", point up on "Him", then hug yourself.

Memory verse

"God saw all that he had made, and it was very good indeed."

Genesis 1:31 (CSB)

Find it! Find the first book

Genesis is the very first book of the Bible. Show them the contents page. Explain a reference: Genesis (book) 1 (big number = chapter) : 31 (small number = verse). Everyone finds Genesis 1:31; first finder reads it aloud.

Story time: pause and ask

- **The garden:** What made Eden perfect? (Not just the trees: God was with them.)
- **The one rule:** Why does Adam point at the tree? (So Eve would remember.)

Act it out: The one rule

Choose an Adam, an Eve, and three or four "trees" (children holding paper fruit). The teacher narrates as God: "You may eat from this tree… and this one… and this one…" Adam and Eve happily taste. Then at the last tree: "But not this one." Freeze. Ask the audience: "How many yeses? How many noes?"

You need

- Screen, Bibles, kids' pages 1–3
- Cloth bag with 5–6 things from nature
- Tape to mark one square on the floor

Week 1 · The plan

0:00	**Arrival puzzle**	Kids' page 1: Match the days of creation.
0:08	**Welcome**	Attention cue. Teach the attention cue and write the class covenant. Then today's big idea with the moves.
0:12	**Hook: Mystery bag**	Hide things God made in a bag: a leaf, a stone, a feather, an apple, a shell. Children reach in without looking and guess. "Who made all of these?" God made everything, and it was all good!
0:17	**Find it!**	Find the first book: find Genesis 1:31.
0:21	**Story time**	Play The garden, The one rule (pages 1–2); use the pause questions.
0:28	**Act it out**	See page 1.
0:35	**Talk**	Small groups; questions below.
0:42	**Verse game: Move it or lose it**	In small groups, children invent a motion for each part of the verse, then perform it for the class. Say it three times with motions, then twice with motions only (lips closed!).
0:48	**Do it: The one-rule game**	Simon Says where everything is allowed except one thing: "Don't step in the square!" Call out actions that lead close to it (hop, spin, tiptoe backwards). Afterwards count: how many yeses? One no. That was Eden.
0:55	**Live it and pray**	Challenge: Every night this week, thank God for three good things He made. Sticker on the map. Pray: Go around: each child finishes the sentence, "Thank You, God, for making…" Then the teacher closes.

Small-group talk (with answers for leaders)

- **What was the very best thing about Eden?** God was with them, and they loved being with Him.
- **How many rules did God give Adam and Eve?** Just one! Every other tree was a "yes".
- **Your mom or dad says, "Don't touch the hot stove." Is that a mean rule or a loving rule?** Loving. God's rule was too.

Sixes

Six-year-olds may not read the verse yet. Pair each with a reader, and let them do the motions and say the reference.

Eights and nines

Ask nines: "If God made everything good, where did the bad come from?" Don't answer it; tell them to come back next week.

Teacher tip

Keep this week bright and happy. The sadness comes next week and means more once they have enjoyed how good Eden was. Hand out the Road Home map today.

WEEK 2 OF 7

The big lie

Book: The serpent · The fruit · Out of the garden (pages 3–5) · Bible: Genesis 3:1–24



Teacher's heart

The serpent's first move was to question God's word ("Did God really say…?"), then to flatly contradict it ("You won't die!"). Eve and Adam believed the lie. Sin is not just a slip; it is choosing not to trust God. Everything changed: shame, fear, hiding, and the long walk out of the garden. Yet God came looking for them, clothed them (animals died to do it), and made the first promise of the gospel: Someone would crush the serpent (Genesis 3:15).

Big idea

"Trust God, not the snake!"

Point up on "Trust God", wiggle a hand like a snake on "not the snake", and shake your head.

Memory verse

"Every word of God is pure; he is a shield to those who take refuge in him."

Proverbs 30:5 (CSB)

Find it! Open to the middle

Open a Bible right in the middle: you usually land in Psalms. Proverbs is the next book. Race to find Proverbs 30:5. Show the semicolon: it joins two halves of one thought.

Story time: pause and ask

- **The serpent:** What were the serpent's two tricks? (Questioning God; then a lie.)
- **The fruit:** Stop on "Uh-oh." What is sin? (Not trusting and obeying God.)
- **Out of the garden:** What did God promise? (Someone would come to crush the serpent and open the way home.)

Act it out: The trick

A "serpent" (a child with a sock puppet) whispers lines you hand them on cards: "Did God really say that?" "You won't die!" Eve and Adam act out looking, taking, eating, then hiding behind a chair. God (teacher) calls, "Where are you?" Freeze and ask: "Who told the truth?"

You need

- Screen, Bibles, kids' pages 1–3
- Pretty gift box with an onion inside
- Plain bag with a treat per child
- Kids' page 3 (the snake spiral)
- Scissors, crayons, string or yarn

Week 2 · The plan

0:00	**Arrival puzzle**	Kids' page 1: True or trick?.
0:08	**Welcome**	Attention cue. Review: "God made it good, and He made me to be with Him!". Then today's big idea with the moves.
0:12	**Hook: Two boxes**	Show a beautifully wrapped box and a plain paper bag. Children vote which to open. The pretty box holds an old onion; the plain bag holds the treats. "The fruit looked good, but the snake's promise was a trick."
0:17	**Find it!**	Open to the middle: find Proverbs 30:5.
0:21	**Story time**	Play The serpent, The fruit, Out of the garden (pages 3–5); use the pause questions.
0:28	**Act it out**	See page 1.
0:35	**Talk**	Small groups; questions below.
0:42	**Verse game: Word-card scramble**	Write the verse on index cards, one or two words each. Two teams race to put their set in order; the winners read it aloud together. Then remove two cards and race again.
0:48	**Do it: Twisty snake**	Children colour the snake, cut around the circle, then along the spiral line, and hang it from a string. As it twists, read the words on the head: "Trust God!"
0:55	**Live it and pray**	Challenge: When something whispers "It's fine, nobody will know," stop and ask: "What does God say?" Sticker on the map. Pray: Ask God to help us trust what He says, even when something else looks good.

Small-group talk (with answers for leaders)

- **What did the serpent say? Was it true?** No. He twisted God's words: "Did God really say…?"
- **Have you ever seen an ad that made a toy look amazing, but it wasn't?** Things can look good and still be a trick.
- **How did God make clothes for Adam and Eve?** Animals had to die. Remember this; it comes back in week 5!

Sixes

Sixes will love the onion. Keep the big idea to one line: "The snake lied. God always tells the truth."

Eights and nines

Nines can spot the serpent's strategy: question, lie, promise. Ask, "Where do we hear tricks like that today?"

Teacher tip

Call the serpent what the Bible calls him: a liar. End on hope: God made a promise that Someone would come.

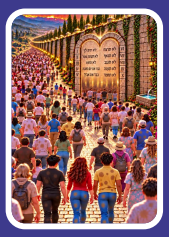
Handle with care

The fruit page has a lightning flash and thunder. The book also says animals died to make the clothes. Say it plainly and briefly; it is the first picture of a substitute, and it matters in week 5.

WEEK 3 OF 7

Every one of us

Book: The long road · God's law (pages 6–7) · Bible: Exodus 20:1–17; Romans 3:23; James 2:10





Teacher's heart

Adam and Eve's children had children, all the way down to us, and every one of them carried sin. God gave His law, the Ten Commandments, and like a mirror it shows what we could not see: we have all broken it. James 2:10 says breaking one law makes us guilty of all. This age group has a strong sense of fairness; they are quick to spot others' sin and slow to see their own. Your honest "Me too" is the most important thing you will say this week.

Big idea

"Everybody sins. Me too."

Point around the whole room on "Everybody", then point to yourself on "Me too."

Memory verse

"For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God."

Romans 3:23 (CSB)

Find it! Old and New Testament

The Bible has two big parts. The Old Testament (Genesis to Malachi) is before Jesus was born; the New Testament (Matthew to Revelation) is from His birth on. Find where the New Testament starts, then find Romans 3:23 (after the four Gospels and Acts).

Story time: pause and ask

- **The long road:** What does every person on the road have? (Sin marks.)
- **God's law:** Pause after the questions: answer quietly in your heart, not out loud.

Act it out: The long road

Everyone lines up and walks slowly around the room as "all the people", with a dot sticker on each hand (sin marks). At the front, two leaders hold up paper "stone tablets". As each person reaches them, the leader reads one commandment and everyone stops: "Have you ever…?" Everyone looks at their dot.

You need

- Screen, Bibles, kids' pages 1–3
- Hand mirror
- Bucket or basket
- Paper balls, 3 per child
- Tape for a throwing line
- Small round dot stickers

Week 3 · The plan

0:00	**Arrival puzzle**	Kids' page 1: Word search.
0:08	**Welcome**	Attention cue. Review: "God made it good, and He made me to be with Him!" · "Trust God, not the snake!". Then today's big idea with the moves.
0:12	**Hook: Mirror, mirror**	Pass a hand mirror around. Each child says one thing they see (a smile, messy hair, a smudge). "A mirror shows what is really there. Today God's law is a mirror for our hearts."
0:17	**Find it!**	Old and New Testament: find Romans 3:23.
0:21	**Story time**	Play The long road, God's law (pages 6–7); use the pause questions.
0:28	**Act it out**	See page 1.
0:35	**Talk**	Small groups; questions below.
0:42	**Verse game: Erase the verse**	Write the verse on a whiteboard. Read it together, then a child erases one word. Read it again with the gap. Keep going until the board is empty and the class can say it all.
0:48	**Do it: Fall-short toss**	Put the bucket far away, much too far. Everyone throws from the line; almost every ball falls short. Read the verse: sin means missing God's perfect mark, and nobody can throw that far: not the teacher, not the pastor, not anyone.
0:55	**Live it and pray**	Challenge: Notice one time this week when you do wrong. Tell God about it, right then. Sticker on the map. Pray: Quietly, in your heart, tell God you have broken His good rules. (No one says theirs out loud.)

Small-group talk (with answers for leaders)

- **What did every person on the long road have?** Sin marks, just like Adam and Eve.
- **"That's only two of the ten!" Why does breaking even one rule matter?** James 2:10: break one, and you've broken God's law.
- **What does God's law do, like a mirror?** It shows our sin. (Next week: what it can't do.)

Sixes

Use concrete words: lying, taking, being mean, not obeying. Never use a child as the example; use yourself.

Eights and nines

Nines will want to argue it's unfair. Let them: "Is one lie enough to make someone a liar?" Then read James 2:10.

Teacher tip

Never ask children to confess sins out loud. Throw too, and fall short yourself: "I miss the mark too." Then it isn't a lecture.

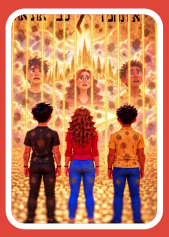
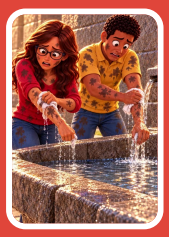
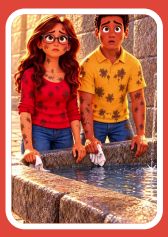
Handle with care

The book says "that makes you a liar and a thief." That is the point of the law page, so don't soften it, but say it about all of us (yourself first), never about one child.

WEEK 4 OF 7

Locked out

Book: Locked out · Can we scrub it off? (pages 8–9) · Bible: Romans 3:20; Isaiah 59:2; Romans 6:23; Ephesians 2:8–9

Teacher's heart

A mirror shows the dirt but can't wash it off; God's law shows our sin but can't remove it (Romans 3:20). Sin separates us from God (Isaiah 59:2), and the wages of sin is death (Romans 6:23). The children in the book scrub and scrub: being extra good, saying sorry, going to church. The marks stay. Children this age are natural rule-keepers and many already believe that being good is how you get to God. This week gently takes that hope away, so next week's good news lands as a gift.

Big idea

"I can't scrub sin off!"

Scrub one arm hard with the other hand, then stop and shake your head on "can't".

Memory verse

"For you are saved by grace through faith, and this is not from yourselves; it is God's gift."

Ephesians 2:8 (CSB)

Find it! The letters

After the Gospels and Acts come letters written to churches. Teach the trick for four of them in a row: "Go Eat Pop Corn" = Galatians, Ephesians, Philippians, Colossians. Find Ephesians 2:8.

Story time: pause and ask

- **Locked out:** What happened to the gates? (They slammed shut.) Why? (Sin locks us out.)
- **Can we scrub it off?:** Name three ways the children tried. Did any work?

Act it out: The scrub

Two volunteers play the children at the fountain. They try everything you call out: "Scrub harder!" "Be extra good!" (they sit up straight) "Say sorry!" "Go to church!" After each, the class checks their dot stickers from last week: still there. "Who can help?"

You need

- Screen, Bibles, kids' pages 1–3
- Box with a padlock (hide the key)
- White plastic plate (keep it for week 6!)
- Permanent marker
- Water, soap, sponge

Week 4 · The plan

0:00	**Arrival puzzle**	Kids' page 1: Crossword.
0:08	**Welcome**	Attention cue. Review: "God made it good, and He made me to be with Him!" · "Trust God, not the snake!" · "Everybody sins. Me too.". Then today's big idea with the moves.
0:12	**Hook: The locked box**	Show a box with a padlock: there is a prize inside. Let children try: pulling, shaking, saying "please", being extra good. Nothing works. "Sin locks us out of God's home, and we don't have the key." Keep the box shut until next week!
0:17	**Find it!**	The letters: find Ephesians 2:8.
0:21	**Story time**	Play Locked out, Can we scrub it off? (pages 8–9); use the pause questions.
0:28	**Act it out**	See page 1.
0:35	**Talk**	Small groups; questions below.
0:42	**Verse game: Post-it cover-up**	Write the verse on the board. Say it together, then cover one word with a sticky note. Repeat until every word is covered. Peel them off one at a time as a celebration.
0:48	**Do it: The mark that won't come off**	Draw a small "sin mark" on the plate. Children take turns scrubbing with water, soap and the sponge. Count the scrubs together. It stays! Put the plate away: "Next week, who has the key? In two weeks, who can make us clean?"
0:55	**Live it and pray**	Challenge: When you think, "I need to be good enough for God," remember: being saved is God's gift. Sticker on the map. Pray: Tell God we can't clean ourselves, and thank Him that the story isn't over.

Small-group talk (with answers for leaders)

- **What does a mirror do? What can't it do?** It shows the dirt, but it can't wash it off. God's law is the same.
- **Ever spilled juice on a white shirt? Did scrubbing get it all out?** Let them tell stories.
- **Someone has to take our place. Who could it be?** Leave it as a question until next week!

Sixes

Sixes understand "locked out" and "won't wash off". Keep hell to what the book says, and move to hope.

Eights and nines

Ask nines: "If being good can't fix it, what would?" Let them guess, and hold the answer until next week.

Teacher tip

Keep the padlock key for week 5 and the marked plate for week 6. Test rubbing alcohol on a marked plate at home first.

Handle with care

The "Locked out" page says that if we die with our sin we will be punished in a place called hell, far away from God forever. Say it calmly, as the book does, then point ahead: "That is very bad news, but it is not the end of the story." Watch for anxious children and sit with them after: "Jesus came to make a way. You'll see next week."

WEEK 5 OF 7

The door

Book: The door · The cross (pages 10–11) · Bible: John 10:9; John 3:16; John 14:6; Isaiah 53:6



Teacher's heart

Here is the good news! The Someone God promised in the garden is Jesus, God's own Son. "I am the door. Whoever comes in through Me will be saved" (John 10:9). Jesus never sinned, yet He died in our place, like the animals that died for Adam and Eve. All our sin was put on Him (Isaiah 53:6). After four weeks of bad news, this is the turning point. Slow down and let it land: He did it because He loves us.

Big idea

"Jesus is the door! He took my place."

Swing both arms open like a door on "Jesus is the door", then a hand on your heart on "He took my place."

Memory verse

"For God loved the world in this way: He gave his one and only Son, so that everyone who believes in him will not perish but have eternal life."

John 3:16 (CSB)

Find it! The Gospels

The first four books of the New Testament tell Jesus' story: Matthew, Mark, Luke, John (say it as a chant). Find John 3:16. Many people call it the most famous verse in the Bible.

Story time: pause and ask

- **The door:** What are the people doing? (Telling others, "Come and see!")
- **The cross:** Jesus never sinned. Why did He die? (In our place, because He loves us.)

Act it out: Come and see!

Half the class are "the crowd", milling around. Three "children" go to a doorway (two leaders holding hands up), look through, and run back shouting, "Come and see! There is a way back to God!" Each time one person follows them through, until the whole crowd is through.

You need

- Screen, Bibles, kids' pages 1–3
- Last week's locked box, with the key
- Kids' page 3
- Scissors, glue sticks, crayons

Week 5 · The plan

0:00	**Arrival puzzle**	Kids' page 1: Maze through the crowd.
0:08	**Welcome**	Attention cue. Review: "God made it good, and He made me to be with Him!" · "Trust God, not the snake!" · "Everybody sins. Me too." · "I can't scrub sin off!". Then today's big idea with the moves.
0:12	**Hook: I'll take your place**	Say someone broke the class rules and must do 20 jumping jacks. Pick a child to come up. Just before they start: "Wait. I'll do them for you." Do all 20 yourself, puffing hard. "How did that feel?" That is what Jesus did, but He paid with His life.
0:17	**Find it!**	The Gospels: find John 3:16.
0:21	**Story time**	Play The door, The cross (pages 10–11); use the pause questions.
0:28	**Act it out**	See page 1.
0:35	**Talk**	Small groups; questions below.
0:42	**Verse game: Discover the verse**	Hand out paper plates, each with a chunk of John 3:16 (about 10 chunks). Without being told the verse, the children holding plates line up in order. Everyone else checks in their Bibles. Then say it together, plate by plate.
0:48	**Do it: Door craft**	Colour the wall and door, cut the door on its thick lines, fold it open, and glue the top panel over the picture. Open the door and say: "Jesus is the door! He took my place."
0:55	**Live it and pray**	Challenge: Tell Jesus thank you, every day this week, for taking your place. Sticker on the map. Pray: Thank Jesus for dying in our place because He loves us.

Small-group talk (with answers for leaders)

- **Who is the Someone God promised back in the garden?** Jesus, God's own Son.
- **Jesus said, "I am the door." What does a door do?** It lets you in! Now open last week's locked box: Jesus is the key.
- **Jesus never sinned. Why does that matter?** Only someone with no sin could take our place.

Sixes

Sixes: "Jesus died for me because He loves me." Then promise more next week: the story isn't over!

Eights and nines

Nines can connect the dots: the animals in Genesis 3, the "Someone" of the promise, the cross. Ask them to explain it back to you.

Teacher tip

Never end on the cross without a hint of Sunday: "But that's not the end of the story."

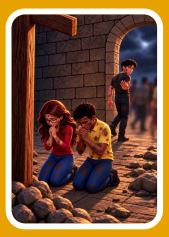
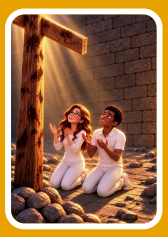
Handle with care

On the cross page one of the three children (Chase) turns away with his arms crossed. If they ask: "He doesn't want Jesus yet. Jesus still loves him." The kids' pages use the picture of the children kneeling in white.

WEEK 6 OF 7

He is alive!

Book: The choice · The empty tomb (pages 12–13) · Bible: Romans 10:9, 13; Luke 24:1–8; 1 Corinthians 15:3–4; Isaiah 1:18


Teacher's heart

Three days after Jesus died, His friends found the tomb empty. He was alive, having beaten sin and death. Now everyone has a choice: some say "No thanks" and walk away; others say sorry to God, believe Jesus died in their place, and trust Him. God then takes their sin away and covers them with Jesus' goodness, "as white as snow" (Isaiah 1:18). Explain the choice clearly this week; save the invitation for next week so no one feels rushed.

Big idea

"Jesus is alive! He makes me clean!"

Jump up with arms high on "Jesus is alive!", then wipe your hands clean on "He makes me clean!"

Memory verse

"If you confess with your mouth, "Jesus is Lord," and believe in your heart that God raised him from the dead, you will be saved."

Romans 10:9 (CSB)

Find it! Luke and Romans

Find Luke 24:6, "He is not here, but he has risen!" Then find Romans 10:9. Romans comes right after Acts. Which one is a Gospel? Which one is a letter?

Story time: pause and ask

- **The choice:** What two choices do people make? ("No thanks", or "I'm sorry, please save me!")
- **The empty tomb:** Where is Jesus? What did He beat? (Sin and death.)

Act it out: Sunday morning

Roles: two guards, three women carrying "spices", an angel. Guards fall asleep; the women walk slowly, sadly; the angel says, "He is not here, but he has risen!" The women run back to tell the others. Swap roles and do it again.

You need

- Screen, Bibles, kids' pages 1–3
- Box with a paper-plate "stone"
- The marked plate from week 4 + rubbing alcohol and a cloth
- Plate from week 4
- Rubbing alcohol or whiteboard cleaner (test first!)
- Paper fasteners (brads)

Week 6 · The plan

0:00	**Arrival puzzle**	Kids' page 1: Secret code.
0:08	**Welcome**	Attention cue. Review: "God made it good, and He made me to be with Him!" · "Trust God, not the snake!" · "Everybody sins. Me too." · "I can't scrub sin off!" · "Jesus is the door! He took my place.". Then today's big idea with the moves.
0:12	**Hook: The empty tomb box**	A box with a paper-plate "stone" for a lid. "Jesus' friends came to His tomb on Sunday morning…" Slowly roll the stone away. Empty! Shout together: "He is not here! He is alive!"
0:17	**Find it!**	Luke and Romans: find Romans 10:9.
0:21	**Story time**	Play The choice, The empty tomb (pages 12–13); use the pause questions.
0:28	**Act it out**	See page 1.
0:35	**Talk**	Small groups; questions below.
0:42	**Verse game: Balloon juggle**	One child keeps two balloons in the air while the class says the verse. Each round, cover a phrase on the board. If a balloon touches the floor before the verse ends, the next child tries.
0:48	**Do it: Clean plate + sleeping soldiers**	Bring back the plate: nothing worked last time. Wipe it with the cleaner: gone! "We couldn't. Jesus can." Then Sleeping soldiers: everyone lies still guarding the tomb. Anyone who moves helps catch movers. Shout "He is alive!" and everyone jumps up cheering.
0:55	**Live it and pray**	Challenge: Tell one person this week: "Jesus is alive!" Sticker on the map. Pray: Praise Jesus that He is alive and makes us clean.

Small-group talk (with answers for leaders)

- **What two choices did people make in the book?** "No thanks", or "I'm sorry, please save me!"
- **What does it mean to trust Jesus?** Turn from sin, and count on Jesus instead of on being good.
- **How clean does God make us?** As white as snow (Isaiah 1:18).

Sixes

Sixes: the clean plate says it all. "We couldn't. Jesus can."

Eights and nines

Nines: walk through the verse's two parts: what you say (mouth) and what you believe (heart). Ask what "Lord" means. (Boss, King: the One in charge.)

Teacher tip

Make clear the cleaner is only a picture: Jesus really takes sin away.

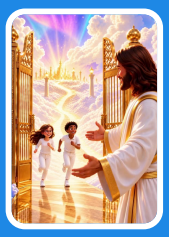
Handle with care

On the choice page Chase walks away ("No thanks"). That is the point of the page: everyone has a real choice. Keep your tone warm, and never ask children to choose publicly.

WEEK 7 OF 7

Welcome home

Book: Heaven's gates · The new earth · Follow Jesus (pages 14–16) ·
Bible: John 14:2–3; John 20:27; Revelation 21:1–5; Matthew 28:19–20





Teacher's heart

The story ends where it began, at home with God. One day everyone who trusts Jesus will run through heaven's open gates, and the same Jesus who sent Adam and Eve out will welcome His children home, the scars still in His hands. God will make everything new, even better than Eden. Until then, Jesus sends us to tell others. This week reviews the whole story, explains A-B-C, and invites each child, quietly and without pressure, to follow Jesus.

Big idea

"Jesus welcomes me home, and I can bring a friend!"

Open your arms wide on "welcomes me home", then wave a friend over on "bring a friend".

Memory verse

"Look, I am making everything new."

Revelation 21:5 (CSB)

Find it! The last book

Revelation is the very last book. Genesis begins with a garden; Revelation ends with a new heaven and earth. Find Genesis 1:1 with one hand and Revelation 21:5 with the other: the whole story between your hands!

Story time: pause and ask

- **Heaven's gates:** Who is waiting? What is in His hands? (Scars: the scars of His love.)
- **The new earth:** What will be better than Eden?
- **Follow Jesus:** Read the A-B-C slowly. Pause here.

Act it out: Running home

Leaders stand at the far end as the open gates. One at a time, children run the length of the room as the narrator reads the gates page; a leader (as Jesus) opens their arms wide. Point to your hands: "the scars of His love."

You need

- Screen, Bibles, kids' pages 1–3
- Streamers or balloons
- Kids' page 3
- Scissors, glue sticks

Week 7 · The plan

0:00	**Arrival puzzle**	Kids' page 1: Put the whole story in order.
0:08	**Welcome**	Attention cue. Review: "God made it good, and He made me to be with Him!" · "Trust God, not the snake!" · "Everybody sins. Me too." · "I can't scrub sin off!" · "Jesus is the door! He took my place." · "Jesus is alive! He makes me clean!". Then today's big idea with the moves.
0:12	**Hook: Welcome-home tunnel**	Hang streamers or balloons at the door. Leaders make a high-five tunnel and cheer each child in by name: "Welcome home!" Ask: how did that feel? It's a tiny picture of heaven's open gates.
0:17	**Find it!**	The last book: find Revelation 21:5.
0:21	**Story time**	Play Heaven's gates, The new earth, Follow Jesus (pages 14–16); use the pause questions.
0:28	**Act it out**	See page 1.
0:35	**Talk**	Small groups; questions below.
0:42	**Verse game: Story relay**	Teams race to put the 12 story pictures (kids' page 1) in order, then tell the whole story back, one picture each. Finish by saying all seven memory verses' references in order.
0:48	**Do it: Gates + invite card**	Make the gates that open to show Jesus welcoming the children home. Then cut out the invite card, write a friend's name, and take it to them: the QR code plays the whole book.
0:55	**Live it and pray**	Challenge: Give your invite card to a friend, and tell them one part of the story. Sticker on the map. Pray: Read A-B-C together. Then: "I'm going to pray. If you want to follow Jesus, you can pray this quietly in your heart with me. You don't have to." Pray: "Dear God, I know I have sinned, and I am sorry. Thank You for sending Jesus to die for me and rise again. Please forgive me and make me clean. I want to follow You. In Jesus' name, amen." Then: "If you prayed that, or have questions, come and tell me after."

Small-group talk (with answers for leaders)

- **Who is waiting at heaven's gates? What is in His hands?** Scars: the scars of His love.
- **What will the new earth be like?** Even better than Eden!
- **Who could you bring this week?** Fill in the invite card.

Sixes

Sixes copy each other. Keep the invitation quiet and personal; never count or announce responses.

Eights and nines

Nines may ask real questions ("How do I know I'm saved?"). Answer simply from Romans 10:9, and tell their parents.

Teacher tip

Invite, never pressure. If a child prays or asks questions, tell their parents the same day. Celebrate finished maps and give out certificates.

Handle with care

Children this age are eager to please and influenced by friends. No raised hands, no coming forward, no "every head bowed" counting. Plant the seed and trust God with the timing.

Answer keys

Week 1 · Creation	Pictures top to bottom: Day 4, Day 1, Day 6, Day 2, Day 5, Day 3. So Day 1 → 2nd picture, Day 2 → 4th, Day 3 → 6th, Day 4 → 1st, Day 5 → 5th, Day 6 → 3rd.
Week 1 · Verse	saw, made, very, good · Genesis 1:31
Week 2 · True or trick	1 TRUE, 2 TRUE, 3 TRICK, 4 TRICK, 5 TRICK, 6 TRUE, 7 TRUE, 8 TRUE
Week 2 · Code	EVERY WORD OF GOD IS PURE · shield · Proverbs 30:5
Week 3 · Word search	All 12 words appear exactly once, across or down.
Week 3 · Scramble	For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God · Romans 3:23 · MIRROR
Week 3 · Story cards	Printed left to right: the crowd, Adam and Eve leave, God's law, the road fills up. Order: Adam and Eve leave, the road fills up, the crowd, God's law.
Week 4 · Crossword	1 across SOAP; 3 across GIFT; 4 across MIRROR; 5 across LOCKED; 1 down SORRY; 2 down GATES; 3 down GRACE
Week 4 · Gift boxes	GRACE, FAITH, GIFT · Ephesians 2:8
Week 5 · Verse	loved, world, Son, believes, perish, eternal · John 3:16
Week 6 · Code	HE IS NOT HERE · JESUS IS ALIVE · WHITE AS SNOW
Week 6 · Verse	Mouth: Lord · Heart: dead · confess, Lord, believe, dead, saved · Romans 10:9
Week 7 · Story order	Reading the grid row by row, the numbers are: 4 10 1 7 12 5 2 9 6 11 3 8.
Week 7 · A-B-C	Admit, Believe, Choose · Revelation 21:5
Crafts	Snake: cut the circle, then the spiral to the head. Door and gates: cut the thick lines, fold on the dashes, cut the top panel off, glue it over the picture. Stone: fasten through both dots.

All seven memory verses

Post this page by the door, or send it home in week 7.

Genesis 1:31 “God saw all that he had made, and it was very good indeed.”

Proverbs 30:5 “Every word of God is pure; he is a shield to those who take refuge in him.”

Romans 3:23 “For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God.”

Ephesians 2:8 “For you are saved by grace through faith, and this is not from yourselves; it is God’s gift.”

John 3:16 “For God loved the world in this way: He gave his one and only Son, so that everyone who believes in him will not perish but have eternal life.”

Romans 10:9 “If you confess with your mouth, “Jesus is Lord,” and believe in your heart that God raised him from the dead, you will be saved.”

Revelation 21:5 “Look, I am making everything new.”

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